Samuel Blake

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Experience

Vantor **Sept 2022 – Present**
Staff Software Development Engineer *Westminster, CO*

- Technical owner of Vantor Discovery API, the platform that powers Vantor's mission-critical consumer facing products, subsequent tasking efforts and the generation of derivative geospatial products.
- Led the end-to-end integration of third-party Synthetic Aperture Radar (SAR) imagery into Vantor's geospatial catalog, designing ingestion workflows, metadata transformation, and STAC publication pipelines that expanded multisource imagery available to government and commercial customers.
- Designed and operated distributed discovery and ingest infrastructure handling thousands of new assets and real-time event notifications daily across 7 environments with 99.99% production API uptime.
- Designed and implemented engineering-wide AI-assisted code review and unit test generation workflows using Augment, enabling multiple engineering teams to adopt standardized review agents that improved code quality, consistency, and developer productivity.
- Selected to the Data Foundations AI cohort to help shape internal engineering standards for LLM usage and agent distribution strategies.

Vantor **May 2020 – Sept 2022**
Geospatial Data Analyst *Remote, CO*

- Developed and enhanced functionality of Spatial on Demand, a geospatial intelligence streaming platform for energy customers, by focusing on a requirements-driven design; ultimately securing 50+ contracts valued at $3 million total.
- Led the migration of energy customers to new web mapping services (WMS/WMTS), including transforming geospatial data into cloud-optimized GeoTIFF (COG) files using GDAL, configuring layer access, and integrating services with third-party mapping clients.
- Implemented and optimized web services for performance and interoperability using a diverse set of technologies, including GeoServer, Amazon Web Services, ESRI Image Services, and a MapProxy tile caching solution.
- Analyzed geospatial satellite data for quality assurance, radiometric scaling, and horizontal accuracy.

City of Lakewood **May 2019 – May 2020**
GIS Technician Intern *Lakewood, CO*

- Ensured accuracy and reliability of city-owned assets through regular updates and maintenance of GIS databases, with occasional fields surveys using GPS technology.
- Developed, tested, and deployed geoprocessing tools to automate data cleaning tasks for the Public Works Street Maintenance Division.

Education

University of Colorado, Denver **August 2021**
M.A. in Applied Geography and Geospatial Science *Denver, CO*

- **Thesis:** *Mapping Seven Urban Tree Species Using a WorldView-3 Multispectral Satellite Image Across the Denver Metropolitan Landscape*
- **GPA:** 4.0/4.0

University of Colorado, Boulder **May 2018**
B.A. in Environmental Studies *Boulder, CO*

- *Minor in Geological Science. Cum Laude Honors.*
- **GPA:** 3.5/4.0

Languages and Technologies

Languages: Python, Bash, SQL, TypeScript, C++, Groovy, HTML/CSS
Frameworks and APIs: REST APIs, Flask, OpenAPI, STAC, HTTP, TLS
Cloud and Infrastructure: AWS, Docker, Linux, Terraform, Kubernetes, Jenkins, Kibana, Grafana, Route53
Data and Geospatial: PostgreSQL, Flyway, GDAL/OGR, GeoJSON, GeoServer, ESRI ArcGIS, HTTP, TLS, TensorFlow, scikit-learn
Frontend: React, Tailwind CSS, Vite, Node.js, WordPress, Accessibility (WCAG), SEO
AI-Assisted Development: Augment, Codex